Fall 2009

The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume VIII, Issue 1

PRESIDENT'S PEN — Fall 2009

By Gordon Cloney

Looking ahead after four years as a CMA Director and four years as DACC Chair before that, I see 2009 as a Mountainside watershed with CMA returning to its community roots based on more open Association governance and renewed member involvement in Association work to restore and build our CMA infrastructure.



Gordy Cloney, President of CMA

As I reported at the Annual Meeting, this change started some time back triggered by the *Coolfont Resort's* closing and an inclusive CMA management policy toward member involvement. Last New Year's water crisis spurred its full acceptance driven by the failing of our aging supply system after a three week siege by the coldest weather in Mountainside history. Just as CMA had lacked a capital replacement program to avert the crisis, no plan existed to deal with the emergency once upon us—let alone resolve the under-lying management shortcomings which helped produce it. This resulted in many insisting on drastic change in the way CMA runs the Mountainside's Water Utility. The old water committee along with its patchwork approach to maintenance was eliminated in mid January. The board reassumed control of the Utility management and later in the year put this process on a separate footing parallel with CMA management to better meet WV's requirements for regulated public utilities.

As a result, 2009 closes with $120,000 in reserve-financed capital improvements underway that will result in a refurbished water distribution system managed by the Board in accordance with WV Public Service Commission standards. To underpin this and avoid backsliding, a *CMA Water Sense Program-*

(continued page 5)

Annual Meeting

By Lois Copeland

Our annual meeting and dinner was held October 17 amidst an early cold wave. This meeting reminded me of Jim Thompson's words in our Fall 2007 newsletter. I quote "The Annual Meeting was sweltering in the barn! Thanks to those of you who endured the heat! Maybe the heat contributed to the shortest Annual Meeting (two and a half hours) that I can remember. If we hold the Annual Meeting in the barn next year, we are thinking of moving the meeting to mid October when it will be cooler and the leaves at their peak color."



Rusty M., Rosemary B, and Linda D. with the ballots !

(continued page 4)

Table of Contents

President's Pen..... 1
Annual Meeting..... 1
Water/Sewer System..... 2
Fire Wise..... 2
Water Sense Workshops..... 3
House Number Signs..... 4
Out and About..... 4
New Board..... 5
Social Life..... 5
Pool Updates..... 6
Bits of News..... 6



Fall

Photo: Cold Run Valley Road

Water/Sewer System Renewal Update

By Jackson Bain

Following the submission of the report of the engineering firm of MR2, the Coolfont board approved the following work plan and a reasonable budget for financing the work which is being submitted to the membership for discussion and approval at the annual meeting.

The technical highlights of the Coolfont Water and Sewer System work plan for the water system include:

1) the replacement of all of the existing "black pipe" that was installed in the 70's and 80's with new, properly sized, blocked and bedded SR-21PVC pipe for the water supply in the affected areas in both the North and South sections. This process will also eliminate the greatest number of leaks in the system and provide greater protection against future leaks on our rocky and dynamic mountainside. The "B" section main line is scheduled first, followed by other sections prioritized by their age, condition and volume of leaks.
2) Repairing and opening the gravity fed connection between North and South systems to allow the North to feed the South in an emergency (the North system produces far more water).
3) The correction of hydraulic errors in pipe diameters to improve water flow in the affected sections.
4) The renewal of the electronic and mechanical systems to ensure reliable and robust operation; that equipment back-up supplies are immediately available, and that staff is on call 24-7 with wireless connection to telemetry devices which will signal malfunctions in any critical system element.
5) Implementation of the maintenance and inspection protocols to ensure water systems and reservoirs are checked for optimum functionality and cleaned on a frequent schedule.
6) Emergency management procedures, response teams and user alert systems to ensure CMA owners are alerted to water emergencies.



(continued on page 3)

FireWise Day on the Mountainside

By Richard Kaufman

FireWise Day on the mountainside was held on April 11, 2009 immediately following a scheduled meeting of the Board of Directors. Board members and other mountainside residents assembled outside the barn to listen to a presentation by James J. Steiner, Chief of the Berkeley Springs Volunteer Fire Department. Accompanying the Chief were several members of the fire department and a well equipped fire truck. The topic of the day was home fire extinguishers and home fire protection generally.

A second *FireWise* event took place inside the barn on October 17 during the annual meeting. On that occasion John L. Anderson, Fire Forester with the West Virginia Forestry Division and myself, who heads the CMA *FireWise Program*, spoke to the well attended meeting.

Chief Steiner addressed the matter of home fire protection. He began by asking, what is the first thing that should be done when a fire breaks out? The answer: in almost all cases, call 911 to report the fire and immediately get out of the house. If the flame is really small, you might be able to put it out with a fire extinguisher. However, home fire extinguishers can be used for only abut a minute or less before their contents are exhausted.

The chief safely ignited a series of fires to demonstrate the proper use of the fire extinguishers. Under his watchful eye, some of us took turns with an extinguisher putting out small blazes.

The Chief emphasized how fast a fire can spread in the home causing smoke to replace enough oxygen to threaten the lives of all in the house hold. In fact, he said, about 80 percent of fire deaths in the U.S. occur in the home and most deaths are caused by smoke inhalation.

To be safe, in addition to one or more fire extinguishers, every home should be equipped with smoke alarms. The smoke alarms should be tested, to assure that the batteries are working and the alarms should be replaced at least every ten years.



Chief Steiner also brought up the subject of home sprinkler systems which he said can be economically installed and offer real protection to homes and household residents and guests, especially children, the elderly and handicapped people. To be effective, a sprinkler system needs to be connected to a separate source of water. This is usually accomplished by installing a large water tank of several hundred gallons.

An intriguing question is whether in addition to fire protection, such a water tank could come in handy in the event of a temporary interruption of the normal water supply. Unfortunately, as we all know, such interruptions are known

(Continued on page 3)

WATER SENSE WORKSHOPS

By Stan Bigelow

As many of you already know we conducted two Water Sense workshops at the Barn this summer. The Water Sense Committee made up of Stan Bigelow, Ron Wohl, Flo Bender and Steve Floyd planned and conducted the two programs with advice from Gordy Cloney, our President.

The "Carry Away" ideas that came out of the "Pot-Luck Workshops are as follows:

1. Conserve the Water Supply—Reduce wasted water. This is a common sense idea that is as important for individuals to control as well as the technical solutions we are now putting in place. To help enable the users get the message out one of our members, Carl Tomason, has made laminate reminders, available upon request, from Flo Bender at no charge. The simple message reads, Conserve Water, on a tent laminate. These cards should be placed in strategic places in your home for all your guests to see. Carl also made a laminate card with 10 Rules for guests to abide by while at Coolfont. These also are available for all home owners at Coolfont from Flo Bender.

2. The second idea was, Prevent Outages: **Install a turn-off valve within easy reach in your home. Turn it off, if you will be away more than a week to prevent unknown leaks from doing water damage.**Turn off the valve at your water meter if you are going to be gone a month or more, in case there is a leak between the meter and your home. This pipe is your responsibility if a leak should occur.**Watch for toilet leaks which can cost hundreds of dollars in lost water if the leak occurs when you are away for an extended period of time. Better yet, take the leak as an opportunity to replace the high use 4 1/2 gallon use tank with the new 1.6 gallon tank. You will save money and water.**Leaky faucets can leak as much as 3000 gallons in a year. Be intolerant of leaks; they are quiet thieves.

3. The third idea was, Recover from Outages—Call an emergency number at Coolfont during severe weather to see how it has impacted Coolfont. The number is 1-888-266-8959. **Call Hallie Kerr if you have an outage, her number is 304-258-0244. you can also call John Hobday, Operations Mgr. and report the outage, 304-258-8141 or cell, 304-582-9404. **All rental agencies of Coolfont homes should be part of the information loop regarding water outages. They should stress our conservation procedures, as well as inform the Rental Guests of the 10 Coolfont Rules. But, remember, the best rule of all is, Water Sense is Common Sense. Keeping informed and aware is the key to using our common sense.



Stan Bigelow, leading the workshop

Water/Sewer System Renewal Update

(continued from page 2)

7) The installation of an aeration system ("bubbler") in the lagoon and the installation of a UV disinfection system before final discharge of effluent from the wetlands into Sir John's Run.

In addition all Coolfont homeowners should immediately check the location and condition of their septic tanks and have them pumped if necessary. Failure to do so if the tank is full could cause a major contamination of the lagoon-wetlands system, and could result in serious fines and/or a system closure.

If your home is rented or occupied permanently, they should be inspected frequently, it should be inspected every five years. If only used infrequently, it should be inspected every ten years. Do you know where your tank is, or how long it has been since your tank was cleaned?



Fire Wise

(continued from page 3)

to occur.

During the October 17 event there was a more detailed discussion of smoke alarms. The point was made that there should be one in every room where people sleep and ideally they should be interconnected so that when one goes off all the alarms are triggered. I brought up a recent incident in which two teenage girls died of smoke inhalation in a fire in the Berkeley Springs area.

John Anderson also discussed ways to protect your home from outside causes such as a forest fire. Recent studies show that among the greatest dangers are embers that can ignite objects on a porch or deck or tree limbs overhanging the home. Providing defensible space around the home by clearing away tree limbs, leaves, and combustible items from on the deck or below the house requires continuing attention.

Photos From Annual Dinner







Annual Meeting dinner. Above left Bob Borchers, host, above Jackson Bain and Jason Geno, Left, Sandy Bain enjoying food, wine & fun.

CMA House Number Signs

By Jean Cohen

About two years ago, the CMA Board voted to have signs that complied with the Fire Department's request for the installation of reflecting house number signs that could be read by emergency personnel. The money for their construction was approved and the signs were made. The numbers on the signs indicate how far your house is located from Mountainside Road. They may be used by fire or police personnel responding to a call from you or your renter in an emergency.

Unfortunately, many CMA members have reported that they (1) never heard of these signs, (2) do not know how to retrieve the signs, or (3) know of no one to install them. The answer to number (2) is that they are being stored at Shane Cheathem's house (304) 258-2984 on Mountainside Road. The answer to (3) is that Shane will install them (for a fee), if you so desire. The board did not vote to pay for their installation.

Please pick up your signs. The Cheathem family would really like to see them out of their house. If you have not taken your house sign or asked Shane to install them, the Board will have them removed from his house by January 15, 2010.



CMA Signs

Out and About

Down the Road a Piece

By Joan Claybrook

...the Museum of the Shenandoah Valley in Winchester, VA is a first class place to visit. It consists of the Museum which tells the story of the Valley with three galleries showcasing a permanent collection, some with hands-on features to delight the children. In the fourth, there are changing exhibitions. The Glen Burnie Historic House is shown as furnished by Julian Wood Glass Jr., one of the Valley's most significant private collectors. The Gardens, which are expansive, complete the Museum complex.

Activities and special events abound. For example, the chamber choir, Winchester Musica Viva, **December 10th**; acclaimed dulcimer player Madeline MacNeil, **December 12th**. These and more treats await you any time of the year at the Museum of the Shenandoah Valley.

Hours, etc: Tuesday-Sunday 10 a.m. to 4 p.m.; Museum open year round; House and Gardens—March 1st to November 30th.

Directions from Coolfont: South on 522 to route 37 South to route 50 (Winchester/Romney exit). Left onto Route 50/ Amherst St,; approximately one mile to entrance on the right.


Museum of the Shenandoah Valley

Temptations By Hallie Kerr

A new restaurant has opened at the corner of Washington and Union Streets. This location was recently the home of The Corner Seafood and Steak and before that, Inspirations.



Temptations

Temptations is owned by Jeff Reiman, who was head chef at Inspirations and other fine eateries around town. He is assisted by his sister, Pam and a friendly and capable wait-staff.

The menu includes many favorites from Inspirations, including vegetation selections. No liquor license as yet, but they will cheerfully uncork your bottle and will facilitate acquiring wine from Ambrae House, just down the street.

Hours are Thursday thru Sunday for breakfast, lunch and dinner, Monday for breakfast and lunch.

Annual Meeting

(continued from page 1)

This years' meeting goes down as the coldest on record. I think this year we at least tied the 2007 record for the shortest meeting. Thanks to those of you who endured the cold!

Hallie Kerr, with the help of John Hobday, procured heaters, which helped for a short period of time. We looked like Eskimos huddling around the heaters. Many left the meeting to retrieve their hats, gloves and scarves.

Thanks to Rusty McCrady and his nominating committee and to all the candidates who ran for the Board. Congratulations to the new and re-elected members of the Board.

A huge thanks to Bob Borchers and Leila Keese for bravely hosting the dinner. Bob offered his home after seeing that the dinner would be impossible in the barn. Members descended on his home and while it was cold outside, it was warm inside. Earth Dog Café, a barbecue restaurant on Washington Street, catered the dinner. The food was both delicious and plentiful. We thank Jason Geno for providing the wine.

(see page 5 for list of new Board)

President's Pen Fall—2009

(continued from page 1)

under the guidance of Past President Stan Bigelow is creating the necessary community understanding while the technical changes are being guided by *M2 Environmental Solutions Inc.*, our consulting engineers monitored by CMA Vice President Jackson Bain. To ease related treasury functions, CMA Treasurer Jean Cohen very successfully out sourced our CMA bookkeeping with a Berkeley Springs accounting firm.

CMA's challenge in 2010 is to consolidate all this and set out standards, policies, operating and maintenance procedures for the Utility. On the financial side CMA would wisely formalize it's largely ad hoc procurement and contracting procedures and CMA must reform our water/ sewage rates to provide new income to replenish CMA reserves. To get started, I appointed two CMA work groups under the Water Sense program's umbrella. One is to study the rate change issue and educate us on it. The other will explore grant funding to complement the capital investment being made by CMA..

Also as reported at our meeting, other good things have also been happening. Looking back a year or two the proactive CMA leadership so clearly required during the Water Utility Crisis was already being evidenced thanks to CMA member volunteers (our best resource) who pitched in to attack challenges in other areas we targeted. These ranged from replacing shabby Mountainside road signs, to providing tot lot amenities for our youngsters, to protecting quality of life by nurturing the *Fire Wise* initiatives and codifying the Mountainside's *Rules We Live By,* to setting procedural standards and introducing committee work plans in response to unkempt Board procedures and to carrying out $35,000 in repairs to our leaking and hazardous swimming pool. Most recently recreation committee members decided to take on restoring our crumbling pathway system and we have organized a committee to guide repairs to our venerable but marginally maintained Barn/ Community Hall and clean up other overlooked Mountainside "gateways" including CMA's overgrown Herbert Quick Drive entrance area, the entrance to the tennis area, the pool and the barn and our roadside rights of way.

All this is good, adds materially to property values and improves the Mountainside. But nothing is perfect and, for example, CMA communications are still frustrating. We have a working website and an occasional newsletter. Last year member contact information was finally centralized after being kept in three separate places. This year I established a telephone hotline for emergency information and a CMA President's email line for notices and reports. But all these components still lack clear central purpose and direction so, too often, our communication is slow, incomplete or trivial. In any case, I leave sorting out the ways and means of CMA communication and CMA communicators for the next administration.

So good works remain as does the growing good will among CMA member volunteers to take them on. For me it has been a pleasure to have been asked to lead the process over the past years and I am grateful to Mary Kay for her tolerance and support. We both look ahead to encouraging participation in our Mountainside life and, with you, supporting our new 2010 leadership.

Meet the New Board Members/Thanks to the Old Board

By Lois Copeland

Our Board and committee members volunteer many hours for the betterment of our community.

Gordon Cloney, retiring as President of the Board, has served 8 years as board member and committee member. Gordy's tenure faced many challenges, most significantly a deteriorating infrastructure. We thank him and the board for their commitment to CMA.

We welcome **Martha Ashelman** as our newly elected Board member. Martha has lived on the mountainside for many years and brings a lot of experience to her new board position.

Re-elected were **Ron Wohl, Arnold Weinberg and myself. Jean Cohen and Jackson Bain** will start the second year of their term.

Board positions will be decided at the December Board Meeting.



Returning Board Member Arnold Weinberg

Social Life on the Mountainside

By Lois Copeland

Life abounds on the Mountainside. Our summer and fall were filled with activities.

Our newly renovated pool opened Memorial Day Weekend with beautiful weather, rave reviews and our traditional Memorial Day cookout. CMA also hosted our 4th of July and Labor Day pool parties.

The Labor Day Pool Party closed out a very successful summer of pool operations.

CMA sponsored two water sense workshops followed by well attended and delicious potlucks in the barn.

The CMA Magic Meadow Playground continues to be a draw for our youngest members and grandchildren. Plans for the playground in the spring includes benches and picnic tables for our parents and grandparents.



July 4th cookout

Coolfont Mountainside Association

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Bits of News

*Congratulations to **Mary Kay and Gordy Cloney** on the birth of their granddaughter, **Lucy Lorena.**

*Welcome to **Michael and Cathy Levey** who recently bought A-6 and are full-time residents.

*Check our website http://coolfontmountainside.org for CMA information.

*The **CMA Directory** has been published. Updated pages will be mailed/e-mailed periodically. If you have not received a copy or wish an additional copy ($5) please call or e-mail **Lois Copeland: 301-520-0225, 304-258-8127, locopeland@aol.com.**

*Our **CMA Newsletter** is going electronic with this edition. If you receive a hard copy of the newsletter and wish for an electronic copy or vice versa please contact **Bob Borchers** at **bob@bborchers.com.**

Pool Updates

By Bob Cohen

You are probably aware that the Board approved major changes to the pool last season (2008). During the 2007 and 2008 season we noticed flaking paint on the sides and bottom of the three pools and found that tiles on the sides of the pools were falling off. Many members complained that the pool was too cold to use and the hot tub was renamed by Rusty McCrady as the "not so hot tub". During the 2008 season we set out to find what could be done.

We learned that the flaking was due to an EPA change in the formulation of pool paint and that the only solution was to sandblast the old paint off and re-plaster (white coat) the pools. We received two bids for this work and accepted the bid from Jeff Allen Enterprises, who was highly recommended.

Jeff suggested that the coating be done in grey so that the pool could absorb more heat from the sun. He assured us that it would look great. He also suggested re-circulating the water from the large pool for the waterfall. The Health Department closed the use of the water fall because we used hot tub water to flow into the larger pool—violating the regulation that forbids mixing water from different pools. In addition, we improved hot tub safety by placing a new railing and a step in the hot tub.

Other repairs included installing two new heaters and a pool cover. The pool cover allows us to keep the water in the pool permanently and more importantly will double the life of the new white coat.

Spring 2010 we plan on repairing the hot tub jets and begin long overdue maintenance on the pool deck. Jeff Allen Enterprises will open and close the pools and respond to pool emergencies.



Getting ready for the grand opening